

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam
Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet



Ashok Nagar library is now a landmark

From a small structure, the decades-old reading facility has now eased into a spacious, swanky and well-appointed building

L. KANTHIMATHI

Following a massive year-long redevelopment, the State Government-run library on 11th Avenue at Ashok Nagar library, has emerged as a grand landmark. The decades-old library which was a small structure is now a prominent building and one cannot miss it.

The redevelopment work, carried out by Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority at a cost of

₹12 crore, was reopened last month. The carpet area of the library has been increased. Further, the lights, walls and furniture lend the library a sleek look.

There are different reading halls meant for various purposes which include reading of periodicals and newspapers, a lending section and a children's books. Besides, a hall where people can bring their own books to read has been provided.

An exclusive restroom has been set up for the differently-abled.

The parking area has been increased. Further, there is a gallery at the parking lot.

The co-working facility called Mudhalvar Padaippagam has also been set up at the library.

According to library officials, the library is drawing a lot of visitors and witnessing an increase in the number of membership after the reopening.

The library has a collection of around 50,000 books and 26,700 members, according to officials.



The library on 11th Avenue in Ashok Nagar.

'Shoddy roadwork' in Iyyappanthangal



Oil Mill Road in Iyyappanthangal on March 21, 2026.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

P. SENTHIL KUMAR

Work is under way on Oil Mill Road in Iyyappanthangal to lay drinking water pipes.

Of the 50-foot-wide road, the bitumen portion is 20-foot-wide and the earthen margins on each side is 15-foot wide.

Instead of laying the pipes on the earthen section, the bitumen part of the road has been dug up to lay the pipes.

The water pipe is just two-feet wide and it could have been comfortably accommodated in the earthen section. Now, the main carriageway has been disturbed.

It may be noted that Oil Mill Road stayed battered for decades and it was relaid just three years ago.

P. Senthil Kumar is a resident of Iyyappanthangal

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Danger lurks on service road in Karambakkam

R. MURUGESAN

The stormwater drain on the Karambakkam section of the service lane in Porur on Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass (near Vanagaram tollgate) remains uncovered and in some stretches it is broken. This is quite unsafe because the drain doubles as footpath in the narrow lane. The service road witnesses heavy traffic due to the presence of many residential colonies in the vicinity.

Further, flouting of the one-way rule on the service road, especially by motorcyclists, aggravates the problem for pedestrians as they are pushed to the edge of the stormwater drain which is wide open and also gives room for head-on collisions. When the metro rail services in Porur stretch are set in operation, there will be a spurt in the traffic on the service road because there is a metro rail station nearby.

R. Murugesan is a resident of Karambakkam

▼
The Karambakkam section of the service lane of Perungalathur-Puzhal Chennai Bypass. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



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‘Chettiyar Agaram Road needs speed breakers’



Chettiyar Agaram Road. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

KARTHIYALINI SENTHILNATHAN

Chettiyar Agaram Road in Vanagaram was relaid around four months ago. It is an immense relief for the regular users because over the years, the road was marked with potholes and therefore prone to waterlogging.

However, speed breakers have not been laid. This road witnesses good traffic because it connects Mount Poonamalle in Porur on one end and Perungalathur-Puzhal

Chennai Bypass in Vanagaram at the other. Further, Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Wetland Eco Park which opened a year ago is located on this road.

Motorists come at a fast clip, especially near Osian Chlorophyll apartment and near the park and there have been close calls. Appropriate safety measures should therefore be provided on this road without much delay.

Karthiyalini Senthilnathan is a resident of Vanagaram

‘Water hyacinth takes over Porur lake’



Porur lake on March 29, 2026. PHOTO: VELANKANNI RAJ B

Fai Banu

Water hyacinth is spread over a good part of Porur lake, betraying sewage contamination of the waterbody. Further, the section of Mount-Poonamalle High

Road from Porur to Kattupakkam along the lake is being misused for dumping of garbage. Appropriate measures should be taken to conserve the lake.

Fai Banu is a resident of Kattupakkam



Unfriendly footpath

S.N. RAJARAM

The stretch of a footpath along Shakthi Nagar on Mount Poonamallee Road is in a deplorable state. It is uneven because the tiles are either broken or not in place. Besides, pedestrians find themselves stepping on protruding as well as broken manholes and construction debris come in the way. Due to so many

hindrances, pedestrians step on to the carriageway and put themselves at risk.

It may be noted Mount Poonamallee Road is a State Highway and witnesses heavy traffic. Pedestrians have to watch their steps and exercise extreme caution while navigating this section. The images were taken on April 1, 2026.

S.N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam

Riveting sessions at science fest in PSBB



Padma Seshadri Bala Bhavan Senior Secondary School in Nungambakkam hosted its biennial Science Fest on March 31. The event witnessed enthusiastic participation from 13 schools accounting for 150 student-participants.

According to a press release, the event was formally declared open by the Dean & Director and Correspondent, Sheela Rajendra, who highlighted the significance of nurturing scientific curiosity and innovation among young learners. The special guest, Balaji Sampath, founder of AhaGuru inspired the students through a simple yet insightful demonstration involving the lighting of the Kuthuvilakku illustrating the presence of scientific principles in everyday activities.

The momentous occasion started with a captivating percussion performance using mridangam and tabla presented by S. Guhanathan and Archith S. Ramanujam of Class XII C, beautifully bringing out the symphony and the science underlying rhythm and sound leaving the audience both informed and enthralled, the release adds.

The fest featured a range of engaging and intellectually stimulating competitions, including fireless cooking, quiz, IPL auction, cartooning and a case study event.

The eventful day concluded with a valedictory function, graced by the chief guest S. Thirumagan, dean, Faculty of Science and Humanities, SRM Institute of Science and Technology in

Ramapuram, who commended the participants for their creativity and analytical thinking and enthusiasm, the release says. A captivating dance performance added a beautiful dimension to the programme, sensitively portraying the adverse effects of climate change on the life-sustaining cycle of rain. S. Vasanthi, principal, lauded the organisers for their tireless efforts; and congratulated the prize winners, the release adds. Prizes for the various competitions were awarded, with Alpha School, CIT Nagar, emerging as the overall winner, securing 20 points. The Science Fest successfully provided a vibrant platform for students to showcase talents, exchange ideas, and cultivate a deeper interest in science and research.

Workshop for women and children

Artist Kanimozhi's next batch will begin on April 6. She takes classes in Tanjore paintings and other traditional Indian art forms, including Madhubani, Warli, Gond, Patachitra, Nirmal, Zulu, Kerala Mural, and Rajasthani paintings. The workshop is open to women and children and will be conducted at SAF Games Village, Koyambedu. For details, contact Kanimozhi at 9381157831

Session on cyber security

Jothi Madhar Sangam, a women's club, organised an awareness programme on cyber security and safety measures recently. According to a press release, the programme was handled by K. Usha Rani, Inspector of Police - Cyber Crime, Central Crime Branch, Vepery. Around 80 women participated, adds the release.

The club is at Sukalayam, No. 70/44, Burkit Road, T. Nagar. For details, call 9841158018.

Free career-readiness course

Chevalier T. Thomas Elizabeth College for Women is conducting a series of free crash courses for girl students of class VIII onwards. The programme is scheduled to be conducted from April 7 to 10, between 9.30 a.m. and 1 p.m.

The initiative seeks to enhance students' employability skills, critical thinking, domain knowledge, and ca-

reer readiness through practical and student-centred learning approaches.

Sessions will be offered across a range of disciplines, including Tally and FinTech, MS Office and digital marketing, psychology, career guidance, current affairs, culture and personality development, and AI tools.

For details, call 044 2537 5753

Toastmaster Club meet on April 12

Raising Pillars Toastmaster Club is organising an open meeting on April 12 at SWRL Academy, Sector 4, K.K. Nazgar. Time: At 10 a.m. For details, call 9962585345 /8925382877.

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'Unhygienic spot near T. Nagar bus terminus'



V. JOHAN DHANAKUMAR

The rundown building shown in the image is near the bus stop that is adjacent to the T. Nagar bus terminus on South Usmaan Road.

The place is unkempt and unhygienic. Liquor bottles and plastic cups are discarded here. It is also misused for open urination. Commuters waiting at the bus stop have to endure the stench. While measures are being taken to spruce up the space under the recently inaugurated Anbazhagan flyover called, the area near the terminus is poorly maintained.

V. Johan Dhanakumar is a resident of Choolaimedu

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A troublesome trifecta in Triplicane



Can you take these three issues and resolve them for us? That is the question residents of the locality have for candidates

PRINCE FREDERICK

Triplicane can do without this trifecta of pains: stray cattle, unauthorised parking on roads around Sri Parthasarathy temple and petty shops that threaten to outnumber dwelling units. When issues fester for decades, people get inured to them, accommodate them, and learn to conduct the regular transactions of life around these pain points. These issues can get normalised to the point they seem non-existent until they raise their deadly horns again. And then these issues receive air time, only to get normalised again. T.J. Ramani is a key member of Srinivas Young Men's Association (SYMA). What "The Alley Project" has meant to Detroit, SYMA means to Triplicane. Ramani weighs in with three issues of this kind.

Not a 'petty' problem

Ramani wants Greater Chennai Corporation to enforce strict zoning discipline that would prevent the proliferation of petty shops in residential areas. While commercialisation of residential spaces is not restricted to Triplicane, this problem has prickly spikes as the streets in the locality are narrow. And this issue completes the trifecta of pains, each connected with the streets of Triplicane.

A problem with horns

Established in 1977 by a bunch of youngsters fired with a desire to improve Triplicane, SYMA has locked horns with one issue, stray cattle moving about Triplicane as if they were part of the traffic. And they are still locking horns with this issue.

He calls it a "critical and unresolved issue" in Triplicane, noting that it has spanned "five election cycles", actually more. SYMA would once again present this peeve to candidates in the fray for the Assembly elections. In January 2025, while taking to *The Hindu* on how to resolve this knotty problem, Ramani had expressed skepticism over GCC's approach to rein in the stray cattle issue by building cattle sheds without studying the issue.

That January, 2025 report in *The Hindu* had also quoted a GCC worker as pointing out that despite a cattle shed functioning under the

A problem wheeled in

The Parthasarathy temple is one of the pivot points in Triplicane, and a sizeable part of the locality revolves around it. Ramani says the lack of a parking infrastructure is exposed during festivals and seasons that encourage temple visits. Vehicles are certain to be parked in front of residential gates.

In his eyes, there are two solutions. One, the HR&CE Department making use of temple land to have a parking facility constructed; and two, Greater Chennai Corporation building a multi-level parking facility in Triplicane that would benefit visitors to the temple as well as beach-goers. He is for the second option due to the wider benefits it would offer.

PHOTO : S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

MRTS tracks in Triplicane, the streets in the locality continued to be "well-hoofed". The worker had underlined an attitude among cattle owners in Triplicane: leave the old cows in the shed, and leave the younger ones loose. The report explained that they were emboldened to do this as the penalty system is not being strictly enforced. It brandished data provided by GCC's Public Health department, showing no cattle owner guilty of letting a cow loose on pedestrians "has been fined ₹15,000 yet". As a new GCC cattle shed is in the works at Narayana Krishnaraja Puram (known as Krishnapuram), it would help to remember that the "shed-and-dread" formula alone will rid Triplicane of this stubborn problem. Offer cattle owners sheds to keep their cattle, and make them dread the possibility of a hefty fine if they think they and their cattle own the streets.

Trials for Bhaichung Bhutia Football Schools today



Bhaichung Bhutia Football Schools (BBFS) will conduct scouting trials in Chennai to identify talented young student-athletes for the BBFS Residential Academy, the organisation's flagship high-performance football training and academic curriculum in association with reputed boarding schools across India. The trials will take place on April 5 at ANE Sports Arena. Participants are required to report at 8:30 a.m. Footballers born between 2010 and 2015 can participate.

Participants attending the trials must carry a valid government identity card for verification. They are required to report in full football attire, including jerseys, shorts, football boots, and shin guards, which are mandatory for participation. Athletes should also bring a personal hydration pack or water bottle, as the trial session will include high-intensity activities. Registrations can be completed online through the Enjogo app, BBFS's official sports learning and participation platform.

For details, call Siddharth Rawat at 7574980867.

Screening for people with Parkinson's

April marks World Parkinson's Awareness Month, highlighting the need to increase understanding of Parkinson's. Parivarthan for Parkinson's Foundation works actively to raise awareness and create a safe, supportive space for people living with Parkinson's and their families. As part of its awareness efforts this April, Parivarthan is organising a Deep Brain Stimulation (DBS) screening session for people with Parkinson's on April 11.

For more details and registration, contact 96000 52531.



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Travelling long to get inked

Over the last two to three weeks, migrant workers in Chennai have been etching travel plans to vote in their hometowns. Associations representing them are seeking additional trains to ensure their long journey to the voting booth is smooth

LIFFY THOMAS

When election dates were announced on March 15, Kottivakkam resident and general secretary of Confederation of Tamilnadu Malayalee Associations Anwar M.P. was furiously scrolling down IRCTC website to book four train tickets to his hometown in Kannur district of Kerala. A resident of Chennai for the last three decades, the businessman makes travel plans to his native place every election season (that includes panchayat elections) sufficiently ahead of time.

Kerala goes to the hustings on April 9, as do Assam and Puducherry. Further down the “poll procession” are Tamil Nadu (April 23) and West Bengal (April

23 and 29).

Travel plans are being meticulously etched by residents of Chennai with their votes parked in other states. And associations representing the interests of those from these states who have “pitched tent” in Chennai for work and business note that with intervention by the Tamil Nadu government and Southern Railway, these travel plans need not be as stressful as they cur-

Poll-related travel plans are not always about tickets. Soaring prices of flight tickets around this time and lack of certainty about train tickets are encouraging voters to undertake long road trips to cast the ballot

rently are.

The Confederation of Tamilnadu Malayalee Associations has made a representation to the State Government to run additional trains to clear the rush of migrants wanting to vote in their hometowns. “This year, we made the representation more than two months ago so that there is ample time to press more trains into service,” says Anwar.

While Southern Railway does operate special trains during festivals and election season, many say the announcement on additional trains is made at the eleventh hour, which detracts from the usefulness of this exercise.

As Easter, Assembly Polls and Vishu come in quick succession, Anwar says there’s demand for bus and train tickets to Kerala.

Natvar Thidar, aged 44 and working as a cook in Chennai for the last 15 years, notes: “I paid extra money to an agent and got a confirmed ticket on Coromandel Express.”

“There are less number of trains to north Malabar and towards Mangalore, so we have made a representation to run trains on these routes in particular. We also need Vande Bharat on this network,” says Anwar.

A similar demand has been raised by the Assam Association Chennai, they want additional Durgam Express/Rajdhani Express/Vande Bharat Express to Guwahati.

Mini Bengal in Chennai

In Sowcarpet and Park Town, Tarun Kumar Das has been working with the community of Bengalis to encourage them to travel to their hometown to cast their vote. He says there are close to 30,000 Bengalis working mainly with

gold manufacturing outlets. “At least 70% of them have their vote in Bengal and we have already started speaking to them to see if they can start making arrangements to travel home,” says Das, who is vice-president of Rexine and Bag Manufacturer Traders Association - Tamil Nadu and vice-president of the Bengal Association.

Das says the Southern Railway must run additional trains to cater to such rush from people. “The construction industry employs a number of people from Bengal and there should also be some initiative from the industry so that they can also be part of elections,” he adds.

Tamil Nadu Labour Welfare and Skill Development Department has already issued instructions that all employers across industries and commercial establishments, including private sector, shops and factories, must grant paid holiday to employees, casual workers and daily wage earners to travel to their hometowns when voting happens in their states.

‘Vote vandi’

And poll-related travel plans are not always about tickets. Soaring prices of flight tickets around this time and lack of certainty about train tickets are encouraging voters to undertake long road trips to cast the ballot. Increasingly many people are seen coming together to hire a bus or van and travel together. Anwar says he has noticed this trend in the last three years, where people pool in money and book a vehicle that will reach their hometown on voting day and they return on the same bus. Adds Anwar: “They are called ‘vote vandi’ (vote bus).”



The Hindu EducationPlus Career Counselling Fair on April 11 and 12

The Hindu EducationPlus is conducting the 23rd edition of The Hindu EducationPlus Career Counselling Fair on April 11 and 12 from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m. at the Chennai Trade Centre, Convention Hall.

The exhaustive fair for parents and students from classes 9 to 12 will empower aspiring young minds to make informed career decisions from 40 plus institutions and help them choose the right courses and colleges. Top educational and financial institutions from across India will be present. Furthermore, career guidance sessions with domain experts will help people discuss their career plans. This annual fair is a great chance for students and parents to explore different career paths, learn about college admissions, and gain insights into various fields of study.

A plethora of options awaits students as they get ready to finish their schooling, much more than ever before. There are a wide range of courses to choose from, careers to aspire to, and areas of interest to delve into. In every edition, the fair has aimed to give students insights into several areas, cater to their interests, and open a world of educational opportunities for them. The latest edition of



the career counselling fair will have all of this and make this experience possible for students by giving them the platform to engage with experts across diverse fields and representatives from various educational and financial institutions. Keeping up with the needs of the students, The Hindu EducationPlus has been organising career expos to aid students looking to pursue higher education both in India and overseas. Spot admissions and scholarships await the students at the fair along with surprise gifts for the first 200 entries on both the days. To know more about the sessions and the fair, contact: +91 90940 41021, 9962226550 and 9841298938.

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Hindu - Education Plus Career Counselling Fair 2026" is powered by Hindustan Group of Institutions, Chennai and Rajalakshmi Institute of Technology, In Association with B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute of Science & Technology and SRM Institute of Science & Technology, Tiruchirappalli. Associate partners are Amet University, Bharath Institute of Higher Education and Research, GRT Institute of Engineering and Technology, Meenakshi Academy of Higher Education & Research (MAHER), Symbiosis Skills and Professional University, Pune, The Institute of Chartered Accountants of India, Vels Institute of Science, Technology & Advanced Studies (VISTAS) and Vinayaka Mission's Research Foundation, Chennai Campus. To register:

<https://newsth.live/THEPCFCED> or scan the QR code:



Travel free on buses and trains to Chepauk

Like the previous years, Metropolitan Transport Corporation (MTC) and Chennai Metro Rail Limited have launched an initiative to reduce traffic congestion and encourage people to use public transport on IPL match days in the city.

People with IPL match tickets can travel free on MTC buses (whiteboard and deluxe) for three hours before and after the match.

After the match gets over, MTC will operate buses from Anna Square bus terminus, Island Grounds (temporary) bus terminus, University of Madras haltover and near Omandurar Hospital on Anna Salai. From Anna Statue on Mount Road, MTC will operate shuttle serv-

es to the cricket stadium.

Metro trains

People intending to travel on the Metro should possess a valid match ticket, said a CMRL release.

The ticket will enable a round-trip journey between their chosen stations and the Government Estate metro station.

Green line stations

The last train from the Government Estate metro station will depart at 1 a.m. towards Wimco Nagar Depot and Airport stations.

Commuters travelling towards green line stations (Corridor-2) shall interchange only at Chennai Central (during the special train services). The entry to the Estate station will be restricted 10 minutes before the last train for each line. The matches are scheduled to be held at M. A. Chidambaram Cricket Stadium in Chepauk.

Essay contest

Nandini Consultancy Centre, a chemical business consultancy firm based in Chennai, is conducting an essay competition for students.

According to a press release, the theme is "strategies to ensure energy security in India." The essay must be in English and must not exceed 2,000 words. Handwritten copies will not be accepted. Essays can be sent to the following email addresses: nandini-chemical@gmail.com / nsvenkatchennai@gmail.com

They can also be posted to the following address: Nandini Consultancy Centre, H-119, Flat 2A, Ramaniyam Samudra, 33rd Cross Street, Besant Nagar.

The last date for receipt of essay is April 30, 2026.

For details, call 044-43540719/ 044-47662241.

Doctor consultation at home

A group of doctors has started two initiatives that benefit the public. They are the 'DrBro - Doctors2Home' and 'Evening clinic @ your home'. Under 'DrBro - Doctors2Home', doctors, along with nurses, would visit homes to treat common illnesses such as fever, colds, stomach pain, blood pressure and sugar.

In 'Evening clinic @



your home', doctors would visit homes within a five-kilometre radius of Virugambakkam.

The benefits of the initiatives include avoiding waiting time at the clinics and travel cost. It benefits children, working professionals and senior citizens, said a release.

Apart from the initiatives, they offer medicines, injections, IV fluids and lab tests at 10 percent discount.

For details, call or WhatsApp 7338830305 or 7338830905.

A haven for puzzle enthusiasts

Rediscover the joy of solving puzzles. Bricks and Blocks, a puzzle studio located at College Road in Nungambakkam, has something for puzzle lovers, geometry enthusiasts and fans of classic board games.

The studio specialises in wooden puzzles and logic games that challenge patience, strategy and spatial awareness. There are hexagonal puzzles, a lock ball puzzle, Tetris-style puzzles (geometric), Sudoku and number pyramids (number puzzle) and 'Pallanguzhi' (heritage).

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